

Stomach Problems

IN BURMA, in days gone by, a **wealthy** landlord decided to build a rest house for **wandering monks**. He invited, or rather, commanded the men of the village over which he **held sway**, to work on the project.

"You will earn **merit** by this work, The announced, "so I will not pay you.

Nobody wanted to **displease** him so all the **able-bodied** men of the village came to help. All except the village **simpleton**. He sat on a **log** and watched the others work, **marvelling at** their **industry**.

The landlord's **blood boiled** when he spotted the **idler**.

"Why aren't you working!" he **hollered**.

"I would have liked to work on this noble undertaking," said the simpleton, rising to his feet, "but my stomach is empty who can work on an empty stomach?"

Seeing that the man was of **robust** build and capable of contributing massively to the task on hand, the landlord ordered his servants to **feed** him. This took a long time as the man kept on asking for second and third **helpings** of the food that was being served to him. But finally he pushed his plate aside, **belched** loudly and went to wash. Then he returned to the site.

Some time later the landlord went to **inspect** the work and was **furious** when he saw the simpleton again sitting **idly** on the log.

"Why aren't you working?" he **roared**.

"I would have liked to work, said the simpleton, rising to his feet. "**Indeed** I want to work on this **noble undertaking**. But my stomach is full. Who can work on a full stomach?"



Vocabulary

1. **Wealthy** (adjective) – rich, affluent, prosperous, well-off, moneyed धनी
2. **Wandering** (adjective) – roaming, drifting, itinerant, nomadic, vagrant भटकता हुआ
3. **Monk** (noun) – ascetic, hermit, friar, recluse, devotee सन्यासी
4. **Hold sway** (phrase) – dominate, govern, control, rule, influence प्रभुत्व रखना
5. **Merit** (noun) – virtue, value, credit, worthiness, excellence पुण्य / योग्यता
6. **Displease** (verb) – offend, annoy, irritate, provoke, upset नाराज़ करना
7. **Able-bodied** (adjective) – strong, healthy, sturdy, fit, robust शारीरिक रूप से सक्षम
8. **Simpleton** (noun) – fool, dunce, idiot, blockhead, halfwit मूर्ख / भोला
9. **Log** (noun) – trunk, timber, branch, wood, bole लट्ठा / लकड़ी का टुकड़ा
10. **Marvel** (at) (verb) – wonder, admire, gape, gaze, be amazed आश्चर्य करना
11. **Industry** (noun) – diligence, hard work, laboriousness, effort, perseverance परिश्रम
12. **Holler** (verb) – shout, yell, bellow, cry, call out चिल्लाना
13. **Robust** (adjective) – strong, sturdy, vigorous, powerful, muscular मजबूत / तगड़ा
14. **Feed** (verb) – nourish, serve, supply, provide, cater खिलाना
15. **Helping** (noun) – portion, serving, plateful, dish, ration खाना परोसा गया हिस्सा
16. **Belch** (verb) – burp, emit, discharge, release, expel डकार लेना
17. **Inspect** (verb) – examine, check, review, scrutinize, survey जांच करना
18. **Furious** (adjective) – angry, enraged, irate, mad, livid गुस्से से भरा
19. **Idly** (adverb) – lazily, passively, sluggishly, inattentively, aimlessly बेकार / सुस्त ढंग से
20. **Roar** (verb) – shout, scream, thunder, bawl, bellow गर्जना करना / दहाड़ना
21. **Indeed** (adverb) – truly, surely, certainly, undoubtedly, really निश्चित ही / वास्तव में
22. **Noble** (adjective) – honorable, virtuous, dignified, admirable, worthy श्रेष्ठ / नेक
23. **Undertaking** (noun) – project, task, venture, mission, enterprise कार्य / जिम्मेदारी



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